Great Swamp Bonsai Society

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June, 2005 Newsletter

Next Meeting of GSBS: 7:00 pm Tuesday, June 14th at the Arboretum.

May Highlights:

May's meeting featured a lecture demo by Horst Krekeler from Germany using a Pitch Pine. We had a good turnout for the meeting and I believe everyone profited by the experience. Horst has a slightly different approach to bonsai than the classical Japanese techniques. His approach is more European and emphasis is on the tree's natural characteristics rather than following the more traditional styling methods.

While Horst brought Charlie with him (as usual), Charlie remained out of sight during the whole of the evening. Perhaps he was still getting over the hectic schedule laid down by Horst and all of the hassles of current-day airline travel.

During the afternoon preceding the meeting, a workshop was conducted at the Arboretum by Horst for several members who brought their own trees for styling. Several members brought their trees to the meeting for display. Lots of good stuff was displayed.

Also on hand for the meeting was George LeBolt from Bergen Bosai. He provided Horst's transportation to and from the workshop and the meeting. Thanks to George for the able assistance.

Some Scenes of Horst's Lecture-Demo.

And the winner is...

The President's Corner:

Mark Schmuck

Hi everybody!

Hope everyone has enjoyed this long marvelous spring we've been having. Just a reminder to all club members to help us make our June 4 open house the best ever. Bring a tree and come on down. It's a nice day, with trees to see, any supplies that you put off buying at Midlantic can be had from Jim Gillespie, who comes over from Sho Fu En Bonsai in PA.

Stay all day, or leave your tree and wander the beautiful grounds of the Arboretum. Bring a picnic lunch and set up on the great lawn. The Arboretum also has a wonderful gift shop.

The advertising has been taken care of, so I'm anticipating a good turnout from the public. Hope to see you all Saturday June 4 at 9:00am . And don't forget our regular meeting on the 14th.

Thanks, Mark.

ANNUAL SHOW / OPEN HOUSE

— June 4th 9:00 am to 4:00 pm Public invited 10:00 am to 3:00 pm.—

You all should have received the fliers for the show, so you all know what's going on and what to expect. And we hope you have had a chance to post the fliers at your local nursery, garden spot, supermarket, or wherever… We're hoping for a really good turnout by both the public and by our membership this year. After all, it's our 25th Anniversary so lets put on a great show. Every member who has a tree (and that's about all of us) should bring it to the open house for display. Every tree is worthy of display.

We hope to see you all there...

June Meeting Highlights: **Martin Schmalenberg**

At our next regular meeting on June 14th, Martin Schmalenberg will present a lecture on *Kusamoto*, or literally: "grass thing". Loosely translated, it is a discussion of the selection, care and use of accent plants that can either accompany your bonsai display or stand on their own. Be sure to attend this meeting as Marty's expertise in many fields of endeavor, insures a most interesting evening.

As an adjunct to the meeting, we will auction several of the remaining trees from the Henry Freud collection. These will be mostly larger tropicals, so be sure to bring your heat and humidity in case our early spring weather persists.

Some Humor, from a British posting on BonsaiTalk, courtesy of **Bart Thomas**

All that glistens … is bonsai wire

Well, today I had to do an unexpected repot on a Japanese larch after two magpies pulled it completely out of its pot in an attempt to get the copper wire off the branches.

They also attacked my Shimpaku but gave up on it when I came running into the back yard shouting and waving my arms about. Fortunately neither was damaged although one of the roots had begun drying out on the larch.

I couldn't believe it, I was in the middle of typing a reply on another thread and just happend to look out the window. I took a double take when I saw what the birds were doing.

I was prepared to combat aphids, caterpillars and slugs this summer - but birds stealing copper bonsai wire? I think I'll use annealed aluminum in the future. lol.

Upcoming Events: **(items marked with a ●W denote a workshop)**

May 28 thru 31 - **5th World Bonsai Convention** - Hilton Washington Hotel, Washington, DC. Go to http://www.bonsai-wbff.org for additional information. This event will include many lectures and demonstrations by artists from 6 continents. There will also be special tributes to Saburo Kato and John Naka. This may be the only time that you can see a show of this magnitude in our area for many years.

June 4: Great Swamp Annual Open House at the Arboretum. Members: 9-4 - Open to the public: 10-3. All club members are invited to display trees for public viewing, regardless of your level of expertise. As in past years, Jim Gillespie of Sho-Fu-En Bonsai will be vending essential and various bonsai related items: Tools, books, magazines, etc. We look for a good turnout.

June 14: Regular Meeting - There will feature a lecture on the Japanese art of *Kusamono* (grass-thing) by Martin Schmalenberg. This is regarding the use of accent plants and objects to complement the display of bonsai. Also, several larger size Tropical trees from the Henry Freud collection will be auctioned. Be prepared to bid!

●W **July 12**: **George LeBolt** from Bergen Bonsai will conduct a "members only" tropical tree workshop from 1 to 5 pm. $50 per attendee, 6 to 8 slots available. This will be a "BYOT" event. George will have several trees available for purchase. George will also conduct a lecture/demo on tropicals at our meeting that same evening..

August 9: No Meeting

August 14: Sunday. Club Picnic at Stillwater Studio, Stillwater, NJ. There will be an open discussion on the topic; "The state of Bonsai today…" Additional picnic details will follow…

September 20. Third Tuesday. There will be an afternoon workshop with Roy Nagatoshi from California. Members Only, $50 per person. Bring your own tree. Details will be provided. In the evening, Roy will conduct a lecture/demo on an as yet unpicked tree, to be raffled at the conclusion of the meeting. Roy's trees were prominently featured in the Karate Kid films.

NOTE:

Unless otherwise specified, all of the Great Swamp afternoon workshops are held at the Arboretum, in Classroom "A" from 12:30 pm to 5:00 pm., members only, 6 to 8 people, $50 per person, bring your own tree.

And don't forget our website www.arboretumfriends.org/gsbonsai . Follow the links to the Newsletter. Steve has also posted several additional pictures from MABS.

ONE FINAL REMINDER ABOUT OUR ANNUAL OPEN HOUSE ON JUNE 4.

The next newsletter will feature an article on the subject of "Vet-Rap" by Bart Thomas. It would have been included here, but I ran out of space...

DUES, DUES, DUES…

For those who may have forgotten, annual dues are due and some members are in arrears. It's still $30 for individual members and $40 for family. See Fred.

June Plant Care Tips.

Flowering should be over now and new foliage is maturing. Now begins the summer routine…

Chinese junipers are the only trees that you should consider for repotting at this time, provided they are shielded from drying wind and full sun. If a tree appears to have outgrown its pot you may safely place it into a larger pot providing it's roots have not been damaged.

Begin your daily watering routine and mist the foliage at the same time, keeping in mind, however, that water left on the leaves in full sun can burn the leaves. Early morning or evening would be the best time for this activity

Continue trimming your trees. Some will tend to slow their growth toward the end of the month in anticipation of another spurt later in the season. Later growth will appear at the tips of the earlier shoots unless they are trimmed back. Keep pinching your conifers as they grow. Deciduous trees that have hardened off can be leaf pruned at this time...

Pine and spruce can be pruned now. Start with the smaller branches and proceed to the larger ones as we near the end of the month. Pruning of deciduous trees is ok, but they may tend to throw new shoots around the pruning site.

Keep checking for insects and disease and keep the weeds out of your pots. Weed roots rob your tree of nutrients. If you have trees that do not show any signs of growth by the end of the month, it may be time to sound "TAPS" for them. If this is the case, inspect them closely both above and below ground to find out what caused their demise. This knowledge may help prevent similar losses in the future. Air layers can be successfully started now.

Wire, wire, wire away on any trees that seem to need it. Check earlier wires to see that they have not begun to dig into the branches. You will recognize the symptoms and can remove the old wire in favor of new.

Your feeding schedule can begin in earnest with a well balanced fertilizer. Alternate feedings of bone meal, blood meal or a seaweed/fish combination with a higher phosphorus fertilizer. This will provide extra needed nourishment for your trees.

Consider soft wood cuttings of Chinese elm, zelkova, Japanese and trident maples. They should "root up" in 3 to 4 weeks if conditions are favorable. These cuttings will likely be ready for individual potting by the end of next month (July)

- Tips taken from *Growing & Displaying Bonsai* by Colin Lewis and Neil Sutherland and from *Bonsai, the Art of Growing and Keeping Miniature Trees* by Peter Chan

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Ideas and offers of assistance for events, or scheduling questions, can be addressed to any of the officers. Don't be shy. Any and all help would be appreciated.